

William (Wenlai) Zhang

Senior Software Engineer

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Profile

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience delivering high-quality web and mobile applications across diverse organizations. Skilled in Agile development and known for driving successful long-term projects from concept to production. Strong expertise in modern JavaScript libraries and frameworks including React.js, React Native, Next.js, and Node.js-paired with a proven ability to build scalable, reliable, and user-focused products.

Skills

Frontend Development

React, React Native, Angular, Vue.js, Next.js, React-Hooks, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Tailwind CSS, Redux, HTML5, CSS3, MUI, Ant Design

Databases

MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Advanced Indexing & Query Optimization

Testing & Automation

Jest, Pytest, Cypress, Playwright, End-to-End Testing, CI Integration, Code Coverage Tools

Backend & APIs

Node.js (Express.js), Python (FastAPI, Django), Java (Spring Boot), PHP (Laravel), RESTful APIs, GraphQL, WebSockets, Firebase, gRPC

Cloud & DevOps

AWS, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), Git, JIRA

Architecture & System Design

Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Modular UI Systems, Scalable APIs, Real-Time Systems, SDK Design

Professional Experience

DoorDash, Senior Software Engineer

08/2022 – Present

- Built the Schedule tab for the Dasher web and mobile applications using React.js and React Native, enabling drivers to view, reserve, and manage delivery shifts in advance, significantly enhancing usability and engagement in high-demand markets.
- Integrated SafeChat, an AI-powered chatbot backed by OpenAI's GPT APIs, into the Schedule tab to facilitate automated, context-aware interactions for enhanced user support.
- Maintained platform modules built with Angular and Vue.js, improving reliability and ensuring performance consistency across the system.
- Developed Node.js backend services deployed on AWS using Lambda, API Gateway, and S3, implementing secure RESTful APIs and monitoring with CloudWatch to ensure scalability, reliability, and operational transparency.
- Leveraged Redux to manage application-wide state effectively, minimizing props drilling and supporting future scalability.

- Established automated testing workflows using Jest and Cypress, reducing regression risks and ensuring production stability.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with designers, product managers, and QA engineers to ensure timely, high-quality feature delivery.
- Mentored junior engineers by providing technical guidance, performing code reviews, and promoting best practices across the team.

Microsoft, Senior Software Engineer

01/2017 – 08/2022

- Engineered core components of Bing Places for Business using React.js and Next.js, enhancing performance, search ranking accuracy, and merchant visibility across Bing Search and Bing Maps.
- Designed scalable microservices using Node.js, Django, and Spring Boot, supporting high availability and seamless integration across services.
- Configured Azure infrastructure and CI/CD pipelines with automated testing and deployment workflows to improve release reliability and reduce operational overhead.
- Built RESTful APIs within a microservices architecture to support core functionalities of Bing Places for Business, enabling seamless data flow between frontend components and backend systems.
- Managed data persistence using SQL Server and Azure Cosmos DB, ensuring fast access, high availability, and secure storage for location-based business information.
- Advocated UI engineering best practices, focusing on user experience, performance optimization, SEO, and accessibility.
- Collaborated with cross-functional Scrum teams, actively participating in daily stand-ups, code reviews, task management (Jira), and version control (Git) to ensure effective delivery.

Support.com, Software Engineer

06/2015 – 01/2017

- Contributed to the development of TechSolutions, a consumer-facing support portal, by building user-friendly web interfaces with React.js and improving troubleshooting flows for customers.
- Assisted in creating Guided Paths®, implementing interactive decision-tree interfaces that helped customers resolve common device issues on their own.
- Supported backend development with Node.js and PHP/Laravel, adding and maintaining features for subscription management and customer support workflows.
- Worked on legacy web components using HTML, CSS, and Bootstrap, ensuring consistency across browsers and devices while gradually modernizing parts of the codebase.
- Collaborated with senior engineers and QA teams to fix bugs, test new features, and improve usability across the platform.

Education

Master of Science, University of Southern California

09/2013 – 05/2015

Bachelor of Engineering, Northwestern Polytechnical University

09/2009 – 05/2013